

them to a layer set, and adding a mask to that set. To quickly and easily copy your Layer Mask, just click on the Layer you want the mask copied to, then click directly on the Layer Mask you want copied, and drag it to the Layers Mask icon.

More Layer settings

If you want to move more than one layer in your document, just link the Layers together. Do that, by clicking on the little empty box next to the eye icon in the Layers Palette.

Change your background into a fully functional layer, by double-clicking on it in the Layers Palette.

If you want to save your personal style as a Layer Style, you can add a Layer Style to its own layer by going to **Layer > Layer Styles > Create Layers**. It will appear on its own Layer beneath the original layer.

Change the opacity of the layer you're working on, by pressing a number on your keyboard. For example, typing 4 will set it to 40 per cent, typing 5 sets it to 50 per cent, etc. If you want it to be 52 per cent, just type in 5, and 2 quickly.

File handling

You can double-click anywhere on your open workspace, to bring up the Open dialog box.

When using the 'Save for Web' dialog box, you can see how your image will look on different platforms by using the arrow in the preview's upper right corner, and select-

ing which platform you want to see. Don't keep saving your images as JPEG, because Photoshop compresses the file each time. Save it as a loss-less format until you're done with the editing.

After working on a Photoshop document for a while, you may have some unseen data lying on the outside of the image. To get rid of this, and hence, shrink your file size, press **[Ctrl]+[A]** to select, and then, go to **Image > Crop**. To shrink the size of your Photoshop files further, go to **Preferences > File Handling**, and uncheck the box that says 'Always Maximize Compatibility for Photoshop PSD Files'.

To undo the save, just press **[Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Z]** a couple of times, until you see your layers coming back. To close all of your currently open images, press **[Ctrl] + [Shift] + [F4]**.

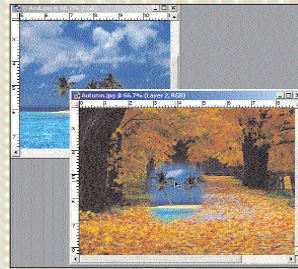
Manipulating images

Use the Clone Stamp tool, to clone from one open image to another quite easily. Just hold down [Alt], and click on the image you want to clone, then go to the original image, and start painting.

To quickly change the size of your preview thumbnail in your palettes, just right-click in an open area of the palette, and a menu will appear with your selections.

Gain lost detail of a shrunken image, by going under **Filter > Sharpen > Unsharp Mask**. In the dialog box that appears, try using a Radius of 1.0 and a Thresh-

old of 4, then play around with the amount until you are satisfied with the result. Crooked scans are common, and annoying. Fix them easily by selecting the Measure tool, and dragging it along the top edge of your image. Now, go to **Image > Rotate Canvas > Arbitrary**. Press OK, and Photoshop straightens the image automatically.



Clone one image into another

Playing with colours

Text colour changes when highlighted. To view the original text colour, and yet keep it selected, press **[Ctrl]+[H]**, to hide the selection.

To get a finger painting effect, hold [Alt] while using the Smudge tool. When using a spot colour gradient that fades to white, make white a zero per cent tint of the spot colour. This ensures that the entire gradient is maintained in the separation.

CMYK colours

If you're working in CMYK mode, the colour picker is still in RGB. To get around this, press **[Ctrl] + [Y]**, while the colour picker is open. This is the Shortcut for Proof Colours found under the View menu. Get the best effect when sharpening flesh

tones in CMYK mode, by applying the filter to the image's cyan channel.

Text effects

To numerically enter the exact size for a type box, hold the Alt key, and click on your document using the Text tool. A 'Paragraph Text Size' dialog box will pop up. To quickly render your text layer, just right-click on the layer's name in the layers palette, and select Rasterize Layer. To get your fancy quotation marks back (the real ones, not the block foot, or inch mark), look under Preferences, and choose General Preferences. Here, you can choose to toggle the quotes with the 'Use Smart Quotes' selection.

Other useful tips

Gradient banding: To eliminate gradient banding when printing, go to **Filter > Noise > Add Noise**. When the dialog opens, enter 2 in the Amount field, select the Gaussian option in the Distribution section, and check the Monochromatic box. Now, just click OK.

View at 100 per cent: No matter what your current zoom level is, to view your image at 100 per cent, just double-click on the Zoom Tool icon.

Kerning and Tracking Adjust: To set the Tracking tighter, highlight the type, and press **[Alt] + [Left arrow]**. To loosen, use **[Alt] + [Right arrow]**. Adjust kerning, by clicking the cursor between the two layers, and using the same shortcuts.